

Seminar Assessment Report

ECO-CO-MATH

Title:	Mathematics		
Professor(s):	Prof. A. Villanacci		
Teaching Assistant(s):	Elia Moracci		
Department:	ECO	Participants:	20
Term:	BLOCK 1	Forms returned:	20
Year	2021 - 2022	Return:	100%

	Answers	%
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Q1. In overall terms I am satisfied with the seminar/course

5	Very much	6	30.00%
4	Considerably	6	30.00%
3	Average	7	35.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	1	5.00%
	NA / No answer	0	0.00%

Q2. The seminar was well organised and well prepared.

5	Very much	8	40.00%
4	Considerably	9	45.00%
3	Average	2	10.00%
2	Not Very much	1	5.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	0	0.00%

Q3. The professor was clear in her/his presentations and explanations.

5	Very much	7	35.00%
4	Considerably	5	25.00%
3	Average	5	25.00%
2	Not very much	2	10.00%
1	Not at all	1	5.00%
	NA / No answer	0	0.00%

Q4. The professor teaches with interest and enthusiasm.

5	Very much	15	75.00%
4	Considerably	3	15.00%
3	Average	2	10.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	0	0.00%

Q5. Where appropriate, the professor encourages class participation.

5	Very much	10	50.00%
4	Considerably	4	20.00%
3	Average	4	20.00%
2	Not Very much	2	10.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No Answer	0	0.00%

Q6. The professor was available and approachable outside seminar hours.

5	Very much	13	65.00%
4	Considerably	3	15.00%
3	Average	1	5.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	3	15.00%

Q7. The overall themes of the course/seminar were developed in a coherent manner.

5	Very much	10	50.00%
4	Considerably	7	35.00%
3	Average	3	15.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	0	0.00%

Q8. Recommended lectures, articles and books have been useful and sufficient.

5	Very much	7	35.00%
4	Considerably	6	30.00%
3	Average	4	20.00%
2	Not very much	1	5.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	2	10.00%

Q9. After taking this course/seminar my interest in the given subject has increased.

5	Very much	4	20.00%
4	Considerably	4	20.00%
3	Average	7	35.00%
2	Not very much	3	15.00%
1	Not at all	1	5.00%
	NA / No answer	1	5.00%

Q10. Indicate the percentage of sessions you attended for the course/seminar

1	Between 80% & 100%	18	90.00%
2	Between 50% & 80%	2	10.00%
3	Less than 50%	0	0.00%
	NA / No Answer	0	0.00%

Q11. What was the main reason you chose the course/seminar?

5	Personal interest	0	0.00%
4	Thesis related	0	0.00%
3	Supervisor's suggestion	0	0.00%
2	Compulsory	20	100.00%
1	Other	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	0	0.00%

Q11. For question 11, if answer is 'Other', please give a reason

Q12. What were the course/seminar requirements?

5	Oral presentation	0	0.00%
4	Written exam	20	100.00%
3	Essay	0	0.00%
2	Written comments on seminar reading or other writing duties	0	0.00%
1	Participation in discussion or no specific requirements	0	0.00%
	N/A - fulfilled requirements in other seminars	0	0.00%

Q13. To what extent does this course/seminar overlap (in terms of content) with others?

5	Very much	2	10.00%
4	Considerably	4	20.00%
3	Average	5	25.00%
2	Not very much	5	25.00%
1	Not at all	4	20.00%
	NA / No answer	0	0.00%

Which courses overlapped with this course/seminar?

Response 1: Microeconomics
 Response 2: Micro
 Response 3: Micro
 Response 4: Microeconomics
 Response 5: Maths is ubiquitous
 Response 6: All of the courses.
 Response 7: microeconomics, macroeconomics
 Response 8: Miroeconomics (for optimization)
 Response 9: With microeconomics and macroeconomics (but this is intentionally)
 Response 10: Micro

Q14. How many hours did you spend preparing (reading, assignments, and other work outside class for this course?

Response 1: 3 hr/week
 Response 2: 100
 Response 3: 15
 Response 4: 15 hours per week
 Response 5: 80
 Response 6: 50
 Response 7: 8 hours a week
 Response 8: I don't deal on hours but I worked a lot for it.
 Response 9: 80
 Response 10: 8
 Response 11: 60
 Response 12: 30hours
 Response 13: maybe 8-10 hours per week on average
 Response 14: 200hours

Q15. Practical classes (ECO/SPS) and training seminars have been very useful for the learning and understanding of the subject.

5	Very much	11	55.00%
4	Considerably	5	25.00%
3	Average	1	5.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	3	15.00%

Q16. If this course was co-taught, do you agree that co-teaching improved the course?

5	Very much	1	5.00%
4	Considerably	0	0.00%
3	Average	0	0.00%
2	Not very much	4	20.00%
1	Not at all	3	15.00%
	NA / No answer	12	60.00%

Q17. Please provide your open comments and feedback in relation to individual professor co-teaching the course.

Response 1: Professor Villanacci was very enthusiastic and tried to make this class as interesting as possible.

Response 2: Pr. Villanacci is very passionate about his subject and very available to help everyone. Although it is something that he is careful about, this passion sometimes makes him rush a bit over points which might seem obvious with such an understanding as his but which are a bit/very abstract for many.

Response 3: The material taught during the class was (and will be) useful for other courses. Class notes prepared and distributed by the professor were very useful in studying and exam preparations.

Response 4: Prof. Villanacci does a good job given the amount of contents he has to cover in the short period of time he has. The course is fit for a math camp, but if we had a bit more time the pace of the class could be slower and we could understand more concepts right away. I also wished to have had more time to go through correspondences and dynamic optimisation, which will be useful later on.

Q18. Do you think the teaching assistant (Doctoral Researcher or Post-Doctoral Fellow) was well organised and prepared?

5	Very much	17	85.00%
4	Considerably	3	15.00%
3	Average	0	0.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	0	0.00%

Q19. Do you think the teaching assistant (Doctoral Researcher or Post-Doctoral Fellow) was available and approachable outside seminar hours?

5	Very much	19	95.00%
4	Considerably	1	5.00%
3	Average	0	0.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	0	0.00%

Q20. Please provide your open comments and feedback in relation to individual teaching assistants (please specify the teaching assistant):

Response 1: Elia was a fantastic TA. Super clear explanations, very helpful and gave great comments and preparation.

Response 2: Elia was very nice, always approachable, happy to help, he told us a lot of tricks and on what we should focus. He is great.

Response 3: Elia Moracci : Elia has a deep understanding of the material and of the way Pr. Villanacci works which was very valuable in order to navigate the course. His TA sessions were the right mix of reviewing the course content and going over exercises.

Response 4: Was great

Response 5: TA sessions were great. Combination of solving problems and providing intuition to the most difficult concepts was very helpful.

Response 6: Great TA that helped a lot.

Response 7: Elia was always very clear and offered a clear, structured approach to solving exercises, He eagerly answered any of our questions.

Q21. In your opinion, what topics were omitted that should have been included?

Response 1: Maybe more of non-linear programming, optimization problems.

Response 2: The selection of content was satisfactory given time constraints

Response 3: I don't think that there were any.

Response 4: Dynamic programming

Q22. What topics should have been reduced/omitted?

Response 1: n/a

Response 2: The first part on linear algebra.

Response 3: None.

Response 4: Vector Spaces

Q23. What topics covered in the course/seminar did you find particularly valuable?

Response 1: optimization techniques

Response 2: KKT

Response 3: Implicit function theorem, KKT.

Response 4: The rigorous development bottom up was very useful for me!

Response 5: Optimization and topology.

Response 6: topology, dynamic programming

Response 7: Optimization

Response 8: Concavity and Non-Linear Programming

Response 9: Optimisation, IFT.

Q24. How could the teaching format and learning results for this course be improved?

Response 1: Its great.

Response 2: Mathematics is the most dense class in terms of content. Concepts may be hard to grasp and they add up quite quickly from class to class. One improvement would therefore be to organise shorter classes (less than 3 hours), because concentration fades away at some point and we end up copying what the professor writes on the board without thinking about it.

Response 3: My feeling is that the content of the course is too dense for the schedule. We had to have extra classes and extend the durations of the already scheduled classes and yet it feels that some topics had to be cover very quickly in order to make that work.

Response 4: It is good. Keep it!

Response 5: The whole course was squeezed into too short time period, which caused lectures to last for 3 hours in order to go through the material. Hence, it was difficult to benefit from each class fully.

Response 6: give him a lecture more time to decrease density a bit

Response 7: Reducing the first half of the course and instead spending more time on the second half will be more useful for the subsequent courses.

Response 8: if there was more time from the beginning, so it is not necessary to organise extra sessions.

Response 9: More frequent breaks / spread class time more evenly. Given the pace of the class, it is hard to keep focused for 2 or 3 hours without some breaks.

Q25. Do you have any further comments about the course/seminar?

Response 1: No
Response 2: It would be better if we continue to do it during the block or if we stop before starting the other courses.

Course content

Q26. Was the sequence and structure of the course clear?

5	Very much	7	35.00%
4	Considerably	10	50.00%
3	Average	2	10.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	1	5.00%

Q27. How much overlap was there between this seminar/course and a previous one you took in your previous MA programme?

5	Almost identical	1	5.00%
4	Considerably	8	40.00%
3	Not very much	7	35.00%
2	Not at all	3	15.00%
1	I do not have an MA degree prior to EUJ	0	0.00%
	NA / No Answer	1	5.00%

Q28. Course content: additional comments:

Response 1: I think this course was too much for people like me who had mathematics last time in high school.
Response 2: Haven't ever had a good and rigorous maths lecture. Was able to follow

Written Notes and References

Q29. Were slide/lecture notes provided to you?

Yes	17	85.00%
No	2	10.00%
NA / No Answer	1	5.00%

Q30. Were the slide/lecture notes clear?

5	Very much	10	50.00%
4	Considerably	2	10.00%
3	Average	3	15.00%
2	Not very much	1	5.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	4	20.00%

Q31. Were the slides/lecture notes sufficient to understand the topics covered in class?

5	Very much	9	45.00%
4	Considerably	4	20.00%
3	Average	1	5.00%
2	Not very much	3	15.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	3	15.00%

Q32. Were the slides/lecture notes well connected with the actual lecture?

5	Very much	13	65.00%
4	Considerably	3	15.00%
3	Average	0	0.00%
2	Not very much	1	5.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	3	15.00%

Q33. Did the professor provide references to other sources for deepening your understanding (e.g. textbooks, related articles, supplemental material)?

Yes	10	50.00%
No	9	45.00%
NA / No Answer	1	5.00%

Q34. Were the slides/lecture notes well connected to these complementary sources?

5	Very much	4	20.00%
4	Considerably	2	10.00%
3	Average	1	5.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	13	65.00%

Q35. Written notes and references: additional comments:

Response 1: The lecture notes are very extensive and most of it is not very relevant, but it is good that they are included for completeness. References to other material was not needed.

Response 2: Professor is writing everything on the board + we got his notes, so in my opinion the material covered everything we needed for exam.

Response 3: Some of the cross-references to theorems and propositions are wrong.

Problem Sets

Q36. Did the problem sets help you deepen your understanding of the basic concepts covered in class?

5	Very much	10	50.00%
4	Considerably	3	15.00%
3	Average	5	25.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	2	10.00%

Q37. Did the problem sets provide insights that went beyond the basics covered in class?

5	Very much	4	20.00%
4	Considerably	6	30.00%
3	Average	5	25.00%
2	Not very much	3	15.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	2	10.00%

Q38. Was the material/references provided by the lecturer sufficient to solve the problem sets?

5	Very much	4	20%
4	Considerably	11	55%
3	Average	3	15%
2	Not very much	0	0%
1	Not at all	0	0%
	NA / No answer	2	10%

Q39. The level of difficulty of the problem sets were:

5	Too easy	0	0%
4	Easy	0	0%
3	Neither easy nor hard	11	55%
2	Hard	7	35%
1	Too hard	0	0%
	NA / No answer	2	10%

Q40. In terms of workload, the problem sets were:

1	Not very time consuming	0	0%
2	About average	15	75%
3	Too time consuming	3	15%
	NA / No answer	2	10%

Q41. Problem sets: additional comments:

Response 1: Problems take unnecessarily long time when they are done individually rather than in groups.

T.A. Sessions

Q42. Was there sufficient time to discuss the problem set in the T.A class?

5	Very much	7	35.00%
4	Considerably	6	30.00%
3	Average	5	25.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	0	0.00%

Q43. If the course had more than one teaching assistant, please provide open comments and feedback about the individual teaching assistants here

Response 1: Elia was great

Q44. Did the T.A. explain harder/trickier parts of the problem set well?

5	Very much	14	70.00%
4	Considerably	3	15.00%
3	Average	1	5.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	2	10.00%

Q45. If the course had more than one teaching assistant, please provide open comments and feedback about the individual teaching assistants here

Q46. Did the T.A. respond to the problems and difficulties raised by the class?

5	Very much	16	80.00%
4	Considerably	1	5.00%
3	Average	1	5.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	2	10.00%

Q47. If the course had more than one teaching assistant, please provide open comments and feedback about the individual teaching assistants here

Q48. Did you feel that the T.A. sessions were more useful than simply reading written solutions?

5	Very much	13	65.00%
4	Considerably	3	15.00%
3	Average	2	10.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	2	10.00%

Q49. If the course had more than one teaching assistant, please provide open comments and feedback about the individual teaching assistants here

Q50. Did you feel that the T.A. understood the material sufficiently better than the students?

5	Very much	13	65.00%
4	Considerably	3	15.00%
3	Average	2	10.00%
2	Not very much	0	0.00%
1	Not at all	0	0.00%
	NA / No answer	2	10.00%

Q51. If the course had more than one teaching assistant, please provide open comments and feedback about the individual teaching assistants here

General

Q52. What percentage was this of the total average time you spent on courses per week?

Between 0% and 20%	3	15.00%
Between 20% and 40%	13	65.00%
Between 40% and 60%	2	10.00%
Between 60% and 80%	0	0.00%
Between 80% and 100%	0	0.00%
NA / No answer	2	10.00%

Q53. What percentage of this time spent on this course was spent on problem sets?

Between 0% and 20%	1	5.00%
Between 20% and 40%	6	30.00%
Between 40% and 60%	3	15.00%
Between 60% and 80%	3	15.00%
Between 80% and 100%	5	25.00%
NA / No answer	2	10.00%

Q54. What percentage of the time spent on this course was spent on general background studying and reading?

Between 0% and 20%	5	25.00%
Between 20% and 40%	8	40.00%
Between 40% and 60%	4	20.00%
Between 60% and 80%	1	5.00%
Between 80% and 100%	0	0.00%
NA / No answer	2	10.00%

Q55. What percentage of the time spent on this course was spent on other things?

I spend between 0% and 20% other things	16	80.00%
I spend between 20% and 40% other things	1	5.00%
I spend between 40% and 60% other things	0	0.00%
I spend between 60% and 80% other things	0	0.00%
I spend between 80% and 100% other things	1	5.00%
NA / No answer	2	10.00%

Q56. Based on your response from the previous question what do you spend this percentage of time doing?

Response 1: Mostly solving old exams, I was quite familiar with the material already so I did not have to study much

Q57. How much of the course material was familiar to you before the course?

5 Most	1	5.00%
4 A lot	6	30.00%
3 A moderate amount	6	30.00%
2 A little	4	20.00%
1 None at all	1	5.00%
NA / No answer	2	10.00%

Q58. Of the material that was familiar did you manage to deepen your understanding?

5 Very much	5	25.00%
4 Considerably	8	40.00%
3 Average	1	5.00%
2 Not very much	4	20.00%
1 Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No answer	2	10.00%

Q59. Additional Comments:

Response 1: Top course

Q60. Any other remarks: